Gode, Shabelle Zone

The Wabi Shabelle floods first, and disease and heat kill afterwards. Move supplies south of the river crossings before the roads close.

REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Somali Region (regional level)	830 forecast, 770 of them January–March; 790 already past (Jun–Sep)	6-month forecast, Oct 2026 – Mar 2027	Deyr river floods; diarrhoea, cholera, and measles after them; heat in February–March

15/15 recommendations checked. 8 corrected, 2 unverified, 5 contraindicated (the five "Do not do this" cards). All 8 For you steps were checked too, and all 8 were corrected. Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data, version of 26 October 2026, pre-peer-review, methods forthcoming. It is published for the whole Somali Region, not for Gode, and it counts heat only. Gode's share was not calculated. The floods, and the disease that follows them, are not in this number. The Deyr is verifying: FEWS NET expects an early, above-average season, and the Shabelle downstream at Jowhar passed its danger level on 15–21 October. No flooding in Gode itself had been reported by 30 October. No pre-arranged money was found that covers Gode for floods this season. The funding target fell by a third in verification, from ETB 55.1 million (US$345,000) to ETB 36.7 million (US$230,000), because the cash and boat lines had no valid unit cost.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



5.95°N 43.55°E, Ethiopia · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** In 2023 only 8% of flood-hit people in the region were reached; in 2000, 77% of Gode's child deaths came before relief arrived.
- **For you.** By 15 November, agree a route to high ground and move animals, seed, and stored grain off the riverbank.
- **The money.** ETB 18.4–52.3 million (US$115,000–327,600); malnutrition treatment and safe water buy the most lives.
- **Do not.** Do not count on one dose of cholera vaccine to protect children under five: after two years it gave them no protection.*

For you, as a resident	8 steps	p. 2
What to do	**10** actions	p. 5
Who does what	RACI chart	p. 12
Where money does the most	funding	p. 12
Do not do this	**5** items	p. 14
What has happened here	the record	p. 15
How this was produced	methodology	p. 17
References	sources	p. 19

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

FOR YOU, AS A RESIDENT

8 STEPS

For a family in Gode or a village on the Wabi Shabelle, El Niño's danger comes in two parts. The Deyr rains now under way can push the river over its banks at night, in November or December. Afterwards, diarrhoea, measles, and hunger kill more people than the water does, and the hottest weeks follow in February and March. The ranked actions below are written for the region, the zone, and their partners. These are the ones you can take yourself.

Agree a route to high ground and a meeting point, and move animals, seed, and stored grain off the riverbank

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 1

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 November 2026	your own time	the household, animals, and next season's seed

In 1999 the river rose in the middle of the night. In 2006 Mustahil was cut off for more than a month and Kelafo's road reopened late. Decide now who carries the children and the old, and which building you go to. The Shabelle downstream in Somalia passed its danger level in mid-October 2026, so the water is already high.

Have every child's measles doses checked at the health post, including children aged 5 to 14

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 4

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
30 November 2026	none: vaccination is a free (exempt) service	children

In Gode's famine of 2000, measles was part of about one child death in five, and vaccination began eight months late. The May 2025 national campaign covered children under five in the Somali Region. Older children and children who arrived since were not covered, so ask about them.

Boil or chlorinate all drinking water, especially river water, until the floods have gone down *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 5

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Now, through March 2027	fuel to boil; Bishan Gari chlorine (one 2.5 g sachet treats 20 litres), price not found	the whole household, from diarrhoea and cholera

After the 2023 floods, cholera spread in the Somali Region, with 772 cases and 23 deaths in about two weeks; Kelafo was hardest hit, and most cases there were young children. Bishan Gari is made in Ethiopia. Ask the pharmacy for its price.

Keep oral rehydration salts (ORS) at home, start them at the first watery stool, and know where to go *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 5

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
By 15 November 2026	pharmacy price not found	young children and older people with diarrhoea

Most deaths from diarrhoea are deaths from losing water, and ORS replaces it. If someone is vomiting, cannot drink, or is very weak, go to Gode General Hospital or the nearest health centre the same day. The Ministry of Health's free line for ambulance and health advice is **952** (relaunched November 2025).*

Have every child under five measured with the arm band (MUAC) at the health post, and again each month until April *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 6

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
November 2026, then monthly	none in practice; treatment food is donor-supplied	young children

In 2000, wasting was part of 72% of child deaths in Gode. A thin child is the one that diarrhoea, measles, and heat kill first. The health post treats severe malnutrition at home with therapeutic food. In Niger, children whose mothers checked them with the band were treated earlier and needed hospital less.

Sleep under a mosquito net after the floods, if you have one; if not, ask the health post

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · ROLE-SPECIFIC

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
From the first flooding until the water has gone	none if you have one	children and pregnant women

Standing water after floods breeds mosquitoes. Treated nets cut child deaths by about 17% where malaria is common (Cochrane review). No malaria epidemic in Gode was found in recent years, and the 2025 net campaign could not be confirmed to have reached Shabelle Zone.

In February and March, keep out of the sun at midday, drink often, and check on the old and the very young*

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 10

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
February–March 2027	none	infants, older people, outdoor workers

February and March are Gode's hottest months, with daily highs averaging about 35–37°C. The tracker puts 620 of the region's forecast heat deaths in those two months. Rest in shade from late morning to mid-afternoon, keep water close, and cool skin with a wet cloth. Confusion, hot dry skin, or fainting means heat stroke: cool the person and get help at once.*

Know how the flood warning will reach you: your elder, the mosque, and Radio Ergo

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FROM ACTION 3

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Now	keep a phone charged	the household, at night

Radio Ergo broadcasts in Somali on shortwave 11875 kHz at 06:30 and 21595 kHz at 15:00 (East Africa time), and takes listeners' calls about the river. No public SMS flood alert service was found. Ask your elder who will bring the warning to your door, and move before dark when the river is rising.

What to ask of the people in charge

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- Ask the Ethiopian Red Cross Society and the regional Disaster Risk Management Bureau whether the riverine flood protocol has been renewed for this Deyr, and whether its trigger was lowered after it failed to fire in 2023 (action 2).
- Ask the woreda health office when children aged 5 to 14 and families who arrived since May 2025 will get measles vaccine and vitamin A (action 4).
- Ask your kebele and the zone administration where the rescue boat is kept, who crews it, and whether it has fuel (action 7).
- If your household is in the Urban Productive Safety Net, ask the Godey City Job Creation and Food Security office whether payments and public works can come earlier this year (action 9).

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO — RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet.

1. Move ORS, chlorine, therapeutic food, and food to Kelafo, Mustahil, and Ferfer first, then to Gode's outpatient sites, before the roads close

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN · FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN · FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Somali Region Disaster Risk Management Bureau, with EDRMC, WFP, the Regional Health Bureau, and the zone	15 November 2026, Kelafo and Mustahil first	moves existing stock; transport not costed	a repeat of 2023, when only 8% of affected people were reached

In November 2023 the floods affected more than 611,000 people in the Somali Region, killed 33, and cut roads and bridges; by 15 November only 8% had been reached (OCHA). In 2006, food went by air and truck from Dire Dawa to Gode, and then by Mi-8 helicopter to Mustahil, which was largely cut off for more than a month (UN, 2006). The rains have already started, so stock that is not across the river by mid-November may not get there.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: local precedent from two floods. There is no study of the effect on deaths. Use in-kind supplies for places the flood cuts off, and cash in Gode town once roads reopen.

2. Confirm by 10 November that the Red Cross riverine flood protocol is renewed for this Deyr, and that its trigger was lowered after it failed to fire in 2023

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ethiopian Red Cross Society, with the regional Disaster Risk Management Bureau	10 November 2026	staff time; the protocol is budgeted at ETB 67.3 million (US$421,179)	pre-positioned stock sitting unused while people are cut off

In 2023 the Red Cross pre-positioned stock in Kelafo woreda, but "the threshold set was realized to be very high for most of the country" (IFRC DREF MDRET034), and the protocol did not fire. Its trigger is a GloFAS forecast of a 1-in-10-year flow, at 75% probability, seven days ahead. It lists Kelafo, Mustahil, and Ferfer, not Gode. It was approved in March 2021 for five years, so it may have lapsed in March 2026. No 2026 activation was found.

Transferability: local. Whether the trigger was revised or the protocol renewed after 2023 could not be confirmed.

3. Make the flood warning reach the door: an elder's phone tree in each riverine village, Friday mosque announcements, and Radio Ergo call-ins

UNVERIFIED | FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Gode woreda administration and kebele elders, with Red Cross volunteers	15 November 2026	volunteer time; unfunded	night-time deaths in villages the warning never reached

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

A warning counts as delivered only when an elder confirms it in person, before dark. The panel's sources say that in 2003 warnings sent to regional authorities "did not reach people along the river", and that a 2023 assessment found the forecasts good but the last mile weak. Neither source could be read in verification (one returned an access error, the other would not open). Radio Ergo's call-in programme on river floods is confirmed.

Transferability: plausible and cheap, but unverified here. It is kept because it costs almost nothing and nothing else in this list gets a warning to a sleeping village.

4. Vaccinate children aged 5 to 14 and new arrivals in displacement and flood sites against measles, with vitamin A for under-fives

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Regional Health Bureau, with WHO, UNICEF, and the woreda health office	30 November 2026	about ETB 160–320 (US$1–2) per child, a global benchmark; no Ethiopian costing found	a measles epidemic among weakened children after the floods

In Gode in 2000, under-five deaths ran at 6.8 per 10,000 a day; wasting was part of 72% of them and measles of 22%, and 77% happened before relief arrived (Salama et al., *JAMA* 2001). The authors recommended vaccinating up to age 15. In May 2025 a national campaign reached 18.57 million children aged 9–59 months, Somali Region included, so a blanket campaign would repeat it. Children aged 5–14, and those who arrived since, were not covered. No 2026 measles outbreak in the region was found, but the weekly EPHI bulletin should be checked.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the evidence is from Gode itself, but it is observational. The 2025 campaign makes this a targeted catch-up, not a mass campaign.

5. Get Gode General Hospital and Kelafo ready for diarrhoea and cholera: rehydration points, treatment beds, and chlorination of drinking water

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MANAGER · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Regional Health Bureau, with the Ethiopian Red Cross and WHO	30 November 2026	ETB 6.4–12.8 million (US$40,000–80,000) for Red Cross water and diarrhoea supplies	deaths of young children from dehydration after the floods

After the 2023 floods the Somali Region had 772 cholera cases and 23 deaths in about two weeks, with Kelafo the worst hit and young children most of its cases (Save the Children, November 2023). In 2017 an outbreak of acute watery diarrhoea passed 37,000 cases nationally, 89% of them in the Somali Region, and WHO named unsafe water as the main driver. In 2025–26 OCHA still listed the region among those with active cholera. Household chlorination costs about US$53 per disability-adjusted life year averted (Clasen 2007, modelled for African settings).

Transferability: regional precedent. The cost per person for the Red Cross supplies is unverified; ask the Red Cross for its budget line before committing.

6. Teach mothers to check children with the arm band, and keep therapeutic food stocked at Gode's outpatient sites through April

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Regional Health Bureau, with UNICEF and the Gode General Hospital nutrition unit	December 2026 – April 2027	ETB 12.0–24.0 million (US$75,000–150,000), only if a stock-out is documented	deaths of wasted children, whom disease and heat kill first

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The last Gode survey found global acute malnutrition of 17.6% (2016), above the 15% emergency threshold; no survey since 2016 was found. In Niger, children screened by their mothers were admitted earlier and needed fewer hospital stays (Alé et al. 2016, a non-randomised comparison). Ethiopia's national programme cost US$122–168 per child for hospital and outpatient care, and US$762 per death averted (Laillou et al. 2022). In 2025 a US aid stop-work order caused a national shortfall of 654,000 cartons of therapeutic food.

Transferability: the cost evidence is Ethiopian. Supplies are 97% of the cost and UNICEF's pipeline already carries them, so pay only for a documented gap.

7. Check in writing the rescue boat EDRMC gave the Shabelle Zone, and clear fuel for boats and trucks under the fuel quota

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · FRONTLINE · FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Shabelle Zone and Gode woreda administration, with EDRMC and the Ministry of Trade	10 November 2026	ETB 18.0 million (US$113,000) for a 100,000-litre fuel reserve at ETB 180.46 a litre; unfunded	a boat with no crew or fuel on the night it is needed

An IFRC report from 2023 shows a rescue boat "provided by the Ethiopian Disaster Risk Management Commission, to the Shabelle Zonal Administration". Its fuel, crew, and station are not recorded. In June 2025 the Ministry of Trade put Gode under a fuel quota as a contraband hub, so any reserve needs quota clearance. Elders should also map who owns boats and which buildings stood above the 2006 water.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: local. The fuel volume is the panel's estimate, not a costed plan.

8. Close cuts in the existing river banks now, and agree with farmers to keep irrigation cuts closed until January

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Gode woreda agriculture and irrigation office, with riverine farmers	15 November 2026	farmers' labour	the river entering fields and villages through cut banks

Downstream in Somalia, the disaster agency counted 366 high-risk breach points on the Shabelle in October 2026, and farmers cutting banks for irrigation is a named cause there. The West Godey irrigation scheme (145 km of canals, inaugurated January 2025) and new canal works since January 2026 add openings in the bank whose flood risk has not been assessed.

Transferability: no source blames bank cutting for floods on the Ethiopian side. Treat this as a precaution, not documented local evidence.

9. Release flood-time cash through the existing safety nets: the woreda's rural contingency budget and Godey City's urban public works

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
The regional food security and safety-net offices, with WFP and its partner OWDA	On a regional flood declaration; public works from November	committed budgets; ETB 15.6 million (US$97,600) held in reserve	families selling animals or cutting meals once the roads reopen

World Bank documents say the rural safety net's woreda contingency budgets cover floods as well as drought, but whether Gode woreda is in it could not be confirmed. Godey City is in the urban safety net: about 1,257 households graduated from its second phase (January 2026), and the region approved ETB 1.28 billion for the urban poor in October 2026. Moving public works into November drain clearing needs the city and regional offices to agree. The only published transfer value nearby is WFP's US$295.83 per household for a March–May drought season (Yahob and Fik, 2026).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the instruments exist, but every one found pays on drought. The reserve assumes 330 households at WFP's value and is released only on a flood declaration.

10. Plan a second round for February–March heat: water points, shade, and heat advice for displacement sites, agreed before donors' attention moves on

UNVERIFIED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CHECKED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Regional Health Bureau, with the zone administration	Plan by 15 January 2027	not costed; unfunded	heat deaths among the people the floods left in tents

The tracker forecasts 150 extra heat deaths in the Somali Region in January, 270 in February, and 350 in March, after the floods recede. Gode's daily highs average about 35–37°C in those months. No tested heat intervention for this population was found.

Transferability: no evidence base. It is listed because the heat number is the one this briefing was asked to address, and because nothing else on this list touches it.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	Regional DRM Bureau	EDRMC	Zone & woreda admin	Regional Health Bureau	Ethiopian Red Cross	WHO & UNICEF	WFP & OWDA	Elders & mosques	Woreda agriculture	Safety-net offices	Ministry of Trade
1. Supplies south of the crossings	**A**	**R**	**R**	**R**	**C**		**R**	**I**			
2. Flood protocol and trigger	**C**	**I**			**A/R**						
3. Warning to the door	**C**		**A**		**R**			**R**			
4. Measles catch-up			**I**	**A/R**		**R**		**I**			
5. Diarrhoea and cholera readiness				**A**	**R**	**R**		**I**			
6. Arm band and therapeutic food				**A**		**R**		**I**			
7. Boat and fuel	**C**	**C**	**A/R**					**R**			**C**
8. River bank cuts			**I**					**R**	**A/R**		
9. Flood-time cash	**C**						**R**			**A/R**	
10. Heat round			**C**	**A/R**				**I**			

What the chart shows: the Regional Health Bureau is accountable for four rows (4, 5, 6, 10), more than anyone else. Elders and mosques do the work in four rows and are told about three more, so they are the delivery channel the plan depends on. Rows 2, 3, and 8 need decisions, not money.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs. It covers Gode town and woreda, with Kelafo where named.

FLOOR

ETB 18.4 million (US$115,000)

TARGET

ETB 36.7 million (US$230,000)

CEILING

ETB 52.3 million (US$327,600)

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

Gode's current caseload of severe malnutrition; no survey since 2016

Floor = therapeutic feeding for 500 children at ETB 23,955 (US$150) each (ETB 12.0 million; Ethiopia's national programme cost US$122–168 per child for hospital plus outpatient care, Laillou 2022) + Red Cross water and diarrhoea supplies for 20,000 people at ETB 319 (US$2) each (ETB 6.4 million; unit cost unverified) = ETB 18.4 million. Target = the same for 1,000 children and 40,000 people = ETB 36.7 million. Ceiling = target + a cash reserve for 330 households at WFP's published ETB 47,244 (US$295.83) per household (ETB 15.6 million), released only on a

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

regional flood declaration = ETB 52.3 million. Boats and fuel are left out: the panel's figure had no basis, and fuel needs quota clearance first (action 7). Measles vaccine and cholera vaccine are left out, because the government, WHO, and the global stockpile pay for them. The target moved by a third (–33%) in verification.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Regional Health Bureau or UNICEF, for the Gode General Hospital nutrition unit and outpatient sites	Action 6: therapeutic feeding, only on a documented stock-out	ETB 12.0–24.0 million (US$75,000–150,000)	top-up	US$762 per death averted, US$122–168 per child (Ethiopia, Laillou 2022)	Partially confirmed
Ethiopian Red Cross Society, Somali branch (Gode)	Action 5: chlorine, ORS, zinc, rehydration points	ETB 6.4–12.8 million (US$40,000–80,000)	direct grant	Household chlorination about US$53 per DALY (Clasen 2007, modelled); the Red Cross ran the 2023 four-region flood response	Partially confirmed
WFP, through its partner OWDA	Action 9: cash to flood-hit riverine households (ceiling only)	ETB 15.6 million (US$97,600)	cash transfer, released on a flood declaration	US$295.83 per household (WFP, Yahob and Fik, 2026, a drought season)	Partially confirmed

A funder's view: split the money. The first tranche goes to floods and disease in November. A second, smaller one should be agreed now and released in mid-January for water and heat, because 770 of the region's forecast heat deaths fall in January–March, when attention has moved on. Every pre-arranged instrument found here pays on drought, not on floods, so discretionary money is what can move first.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives here.

Do not count on one dose of cholera vaccine to protect children under five*

CONTRAINDICATED

Reactive campaigns now give one dose. In the largest trial, one dose protected 40% of people overall but only 16% of children aged 1–4, a result that could be zero (Qadri et al., *NEJM* 2016). After two years, protection in children under five was −13% (Qadri et al., *Lancet Infectious Diseases* 2018). In Kelafo in 2023 most cholera cases were young children.

Instead: vaccinate if an outbreak is declared, but protect young children with safe water, ORS at home, and fast treatment (action 5).

Do not gather malnourished children at central food distribution sites before they are vaccinated against measles

CONTRAINDICATED

In Gode in 2000, relief at central sites "may have increased disease transmission and mortality by attracting non-immune malnourished people" (ENN Field Exchange), and a measles campaign big enough to stop the epidemic came only in August 2000.

Instead: vaccinate at the point of registration, and distribute closer to where people live (actions 1 and 4).

Do not stockpile only in Gode town and assume trucks will reach Kelafo and Mustahil in November and December

CONTRAINDICATED

In 2006 Mustahil was largely cut off for more than a month and supplies had to go on by helicopter from Gode; trucks were stranded in mud. In 2023, cut roads and bridges held reach to 8%.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: move stock across the river first, before mid-November (action 1).

Do not build new earth dykes along the Shabelle this season

CONTRAINDICATED

Earth banks on this river are breached and cut faster than they can be repaired: 366 high-risk breach points were counted downstream in October 2026, with insecurity and farmers' irrigation cuts named as causes. A new bank built in the weeks before a flood is untested and can trap water behind it.

Instead: close the cuts in the banks that exist, and agree with farmers to keep them closed (action 8).

Do not wait for pre-arranged money to pay for a flood in Gode

CONTRAINDICATED

OCHA's anticipatory framework for Ethiopia, WFP's anticipatory action, and the DRIVE livestock insurance all pay on drought, not floods. Ethiopia has no ARC cover. The Red Cross flood protocol lists the downstream woredas, not Gode, did not fire in 2023, and may have expired in March 2026. Planning that waits for a trigger to pay will wait past the flood.

Instead: confirm the Red Cross protocol now (action 2), and fund the first tranche from discretionary money.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1997 (Oct–Nov)	Deyr floods during a strong El Niño; Gode was the relief hub, supplied by air	297 dead and 65,000 displaced in the Somali Region (IRIN, 25 Nov 1997, an early official estimate; not re-verified)	Rift Valley fever followed in the wider Horn
2000	Famine in Gode after drought	Under-five deaths 6.8 per 10,000 a day; 77% before relief arrived	Measles vaccination began only in August 2000

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2006 (Oct–Nov)	Wabi Shabelle floods, weak El Niño; Kelafo and Mustahil worst hit	66–79 dead across the region; 10 in Gode woreda	Mustahil reached by helicopter from Gode
2017	Acute watery diarrhoea outbreak during drought	37,459 cases and 784 deaths nationally by late June, 89% of cases in the Somali Region	WHO named unsafe water as the main driver
2023 (Nov)	Deyr floods during El Niño	33 dead; more than 611,000 affected; 8% reached by 15 November	The Red Cross trigger was found "very high" and sent for review
2023 (Nov)	Cholera after the floods; Kelafo worst hit	772 cases and 23 deaths in about two weeks	—
2025 (May)	National measles campaign reached the Somali Region	—	Children under five covered; older children not
2026 (Oct)	The Shabelle downstream at Jowhar passed its danger level	No flooding in Gode reported by 30 October	—

The recurrence nobody has noticed: Gode's deaths come after the disaster, not during it. Floods here kill dozens, while the measles, diarrhoea, and hunger that follow have killed far more, and the help that reached people early and close to home is what worked.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Stock three months of food in Gode and forward stores** versus **in-kind food invites diversion; use cash**. The Food Supply Chain lens backs large stocks; the Skeptic points to the 2023 nationwide aid pause over diversion (the Somali Region was named only by anonymous sources). The reconciliation used here: in-kind supplies for places the flood cuts off, cash in Gode town once roads reopen, with third-party monitoring.
- **Floods and disease first, through December** versus **heat is where the forecast deaths are**. The Skeptic would keep money on floods, cholera, and malaria until the water drops. The Philanthropist and Emergency Manager point out that 770 of the 830 forecast heat deaths fall in January–March. A second tranche agreed now settles both.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **A mass measles campaign** versus **a targeted catch-up**. The Public Health and Historian lenses, reading Gode's 2000 record, wanted vaccination up to age 15. Verification found the May 2025 campaign had already reached under-fives, so the case is now for children aged 5 to 14 and new arrivals.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

People crossing from Somalia. FEWS NET warns of a credible risk of famine in southern Somalia from October 2026 to January 2027, on the same river. Families who cross into Shabelle Zone will arrive hungry, unvaccinated, and outside every list in this plan. No lens planned for them. A second gap: no survey of child malnutrition in Gode since 2016, so every nutrition figure here is a guess at scale.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at regional level (the whole Somali Region), not at town scale. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; flood, diarrhoea, cholera, measles, and hunger are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED — METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The location was taken as given: Gode (Godey), the capital of Shabelle Zone, and its woreda on the Wabi Shabelle, with the downstream woredas of Kelafo, Mustahil, and Ferfer where the record or an action names them. Climate Impact Lab figures exist only for the Somali Region (GADM ETH.9_1); town detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data, file `v261026_adm1_output_BASE_rounded_cust.csv` (version of 26 October 2026, pre-peer-review): Somali Region, 790 additional heat deaths June–September 2026, 830 forecast October 2026 – March 2027 (October −62, November 30, December 81, January 150, February 270, March 350), 1,600 in total; Ethiopia, 12,200; the world, 857,400. The negative October figure means the forecast has fewer heat deaths than usual that month. This update supersedes the September report *451,000 at Risk*. Method: ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts applied to temperature–mortality relationships against a

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

1996–2025 baseline. The figures count heat only; we inferred this from the data, because cold countries show exactly zero in every winter month. They are never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections.

- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list. Two panel proposals were dropped in verification: a credit guarantee for traders (no precedent, and the stocking window had closed) and recession-planting seed (thin sourcing).
- **Verification.** Six verifier agents checked the recommendations on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability in this jurisdiction, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist. Food actions were checked for whether their price series are actually published and when. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed. Action 3 was not in a verifier's batch; its two sources were checked afterwards and could not be read, so it is marked unverified.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not consulted in this run. The inventory loads its data in the browser, and verifiers could not read it. No action here should be read as having no precedent; none was checked.
- **Money.** Costs are shown in Ethiopian birr (ETB) with US dollars in parentheses, at ETB 159.70 = US$1, the weighted average of the National Bank of Ethiopia's 31st foreign-exchange auction (27 October 2026, as reported by Capital Ethiopia). It is an auction rate, not a mid rate; forex bureaus quoted about ETB 177 in August 2026.
- **Reader.** No role was given, so the For you section is written for a resident. Its steps were taken from the verified actions and from what the panel found about households here. Any step not drawn from a ranked action was verified on the same three tests. The rest of the report is written for the region, the zone, and their partners.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Language.** A Somali translation (Af-Soomaali) is provided beside this English version, because Somali is the language of Gode and of the Somali Regional State government. An Amharic edition, in Ethiopia's federal working language, was added on 31 October 2026.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (water treatment, oral rehydration salts, danger signs, malnutrition checks for children, heat, and cholera vaccination) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. Several sources refused direct reads (OCHA's 2023 flash update, a 2003 OCHA report, a 2023 flood assessment). No 2025–26 birr price was found for ORS, chlorine, or food in Gode, and no malnutrition survey for Gode since 2016. The 1997 toll and the 2003 toll could not be re-verified. The locator map shows Gode at country scale.

References · status after verification

Climate Impact Lab, El Niño Heat Mortality Tracker data v261026 (downloaded 30 Oct 2026); tracker · confirmed

Floods and response: ReliefWeb, 2023 floods; IFRC DREF MDRET034; Red Cross flood protocol EAP2021ET01; Anticipation Hub, Ethiopia; UN, 2006 floods; IRIN, 2006 floods; IRIN, 1999; IRIN, 1997; Jowhar river level, Oct 2026; 366 breach points; ICPAC, Oct–Dec 2026; FEWS NET, Aug 2026; West Godey irrigation; Radio Ergo; Radio Ergo call-ins · partially confirmed (1997 toll and the 2003 OCHA report: unverified)

Health: Salama et al. 2001; ENN, Gode 2000; WHO, 2025 measles campaign; cholera, Nov 2023; MSF, 2017 outbreak; Qadri 2018; Qadri 2016; Alé 2016; Laillou 2022; Gode GAM, 2016; RUTF shortfall, 2025; Clasen 2007; Cochrane, nets; 952 health line; Bishan Gari; Gode climate · partially confirmed

Money: NBE auction, 27 Oct 2026; WFP anticipatory cash, 2026; PSNP contingency budgets; Godey City urban safety net; ETB 1.28 billion, Oct 2026; DRIVE term sheet; OWDA and WFP in Gode; fuel quota; diesel price · partially confirmed

Food: WFP Ethiopia brief, Dec 2025; aid diversion, 2023; inflation; CHIRPS · partially confirmed

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 30 October 2026 for Gode, Shabelle Zone. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.